UPOU Academic Procedures: Student Applications

Office of the University Registrar, University of the Philippines Open University

Compiled from registrar.upou.edu.ph/academic-procedures — retrieved 10 November 2026

The Academic Procedures set out the steps students, faculty, and staff follow so that university academic standards are met. This document compiles the 18 application procedures listed on the page. Always confirm deadlines in the current Academic Calendar and download the latest forms from the source links before filing.

Summary of Applications

Application	Where to file	Fee
1. Application for Change of Matriculation	Student Portal (AIMS)	Fees shown in the Student Portal after approval
2. Application for Comprehensive Examination	Email to Faculty of Study	₱200.00
3. Application for Completion of EXT / Removal of 4.0	Student Portal + Faculty of Study	None stated
4. Application for Cross-Enrollment / Cross-Registration	Varies by direction (see below)	None stated
5. Application for Dropping of Courses	Student Portal (AIMS)	₱10.00 per unit
6. Application for Graduation	Faculty of Study (cc: Records Section)	None for the application (₱300 graduation fee is paid under University Clearance)
7. Application for Honorable Dismissal	Student Portal (AIMS)	None stated
8. Application for Leave of Absence (LOA)	Student Portal (AIMS)	₱150.00
9. Application for Make-up Examination	Faculty of Study (cc: Records Section)	None stated
10. Application for Non-Degree	OUR Registration Section	None stated
11. Application for Readmission	Student Portal (AIMS)	₱225.00
12. Application for Shifting of Program (Undergraduate)	Current Faculty of Study	None stated
13. Application for Transfer of Program (Graduate)	Current Faculty of Study	None stated
14. Application for Transfer of Credits (TOC)	Student Portal (AIMS)	None stated
15. Application for Faculty of Study Clearance	Faculty of Study	None stated
16. Application for University Clearance	Student Portal (AIMS)	₱300.00 graduation fee (graduating students only)
17. Application for Underloading (Undergraduate)	Online Registration System (ORS)	None stated
18. Application for Overloading	Online Registration System (ORS)	None stated

Abbreviations: OUR – Office of the University Registrar; AIMS – Student Portal; ORS – Online Registration System; OAS – Online Application System; FEd – Faculty of Education; FICS – Faculty of Information and Communication Studies; FMDS – Faculty of Management and Development Studies; MRR – Maximum Residency Rule; AWOL – Absence Without Official Leave.

1. Application for Change of Matriculation

Change of matriculation covers adding, cancelling, or changing one or more courses after a student is already officially registered.

Procedure

Step 1. Log in to the Student Portal and open Application for Change of Matriculation.

Step 2. Choose the type of application: (a) cancellation of course(s), (b) addition of course(s), or (c) a combination of cancellation and addition.

Step 3. Pick the reason for each application from the dropdown list.

Step 4. Click Submit once the application is final. A system notification is sent when the Faculty Office receives it; it is then acted on by the Program Chair, the Faculty Secretary, and the Dean, in that order.

Step 5. If approved, click Proceed to Payment and settle the fees shown in the system. If disapproved, email your Program Chair for clarification.

Step 6. Upload your Proof of Payment (POP) to the system.

Step 7. The OUR Registration Section verifies the payment.

Step 8. Once the payment is verified, the OUR processes the request.

Reminders / Notes

- Track the status of the application in the AIMS Student Portal.
- Direct questions about the status to your Faculty of Study (FOS).
- Report processing discrepancies to the Office of the University Registrar by email.

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/change-matriculation/

2. Application for Comprehensive Examination

Students must first consult their Program Chair about the requirements to be met before taking the comprehensive exam. Exam schedules are set by the Faculty of Study.

Requirements

- Accomplished Application Form for Comprehensive Examination
- Official receipt for the ₱200.00 application fee (see Procedures for Payment of Fees)

Procedure

Step 1. Email scanned copies of the complete requirements to your Faculty of Study (FEd, FMDS, or FICS).

Step 2. Wait for the Faculty of Study to email further instructions.

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/application-for-comprehensive-exam/

3. Application for Completion of EXT / Removal of 4.0

Applies to students with a grade of EXT or 4.0.

EXT (Extended) is given when a student fails to submit any one course requirement. Completing it may involve submitting assignments, taking exams, or other work the faculty-in-charge (FIC) requires.

A 4.0 may be removed by repeating the course successfully or by passing a re-examination within the removal period. Passing the re-exam earns 3.0; failing it earns 5.0. A 4.0 automatically becomes 5.0 once the one-year grace period lapses.

Guidelines / Policies

- The student must be currently enrolled or on residency in the term of application. Students on AWOL must first apply for readmission.
- Applications are filed through the Student Portal, from the start of classes until one day after the deadline for completion/removal (see the Academic Calendar).
- An approved application is valid only for the term it is filed. Contact the course FIC before submitting lacking requirements. All requirements and any removal exam must be completed within that term; otherwise a new application is needed for the next term.
- If the one-year period to complete the EXT or remove the 4.0 has lapsed, the student must re-enroll in the course.

Procedure

Step 1. Log in to the Student Portal and apply for completion or removal.

Step 2. Submit a printed copy of the application to your Faculty of Study (FEd, FICS, or FMDS) together with any lacking requirements. If the lacking requirement is an exam, ask the Faculty Office for the exam details.

Step 3. Wait for email updates from the Faculty of Study.

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/application-for-completion-of-ext/

4. Application for Cross-Enrollment / Cross-Registration

Cross-enrollment means enrolling in an academic unit outside the home unit. It requires approval of the Deans, through the Faculty/College Secretaries of both the home unit and the accepting unit.

A. From UPOU to another UP unit or a school outside the UP System

Requirements

- Accomplished Permit to Cross Register Form

Procedure

Step 1. Submit the accomplished Permit to Cross Register Form to your Faculty of Study (FEd, FICS, or FMDS).

Step 2. Wait for the OUR to email the result.

Step 3. Secure the approval of the Dean and Registrar of the accepting unit.

Step 4. Complete enrollment in the accepting unit within its registration period.

Step 5. Once registered, submit a copy of the final certificate of registration (UP Form 5, Dean's copy) to the Office of the University Registrar, UP Open University, National Highway, Maahas, Los Baños, Laguna 4031.

B. From another UP unit to UPOU

Requirements

- Accomplished UPOU cross-enrollment application (online Google Form)
- Accomplished Permit to Cross Register Form from the home UP unit, showing approval of the home unit's Dean and Registrar

Procedure

Step 1. Secure the necessary permit/documents from your home UP unit.

Step 2. Fill out the UPOU cross-enrollment online form and upload the signed cross-enrollment application from your home campus plus any supporting documents (e.g., free tuition, TFE/reduced fee).

Step 3. The UPOU Registration Section forwards the application to the concerned Faculty of Study for evaluation. Approval of the UPOU Faculty Dean, on the Program Chair's recommendation, is also required.

Step 4. The Faculty of Study returns the evaluated application to the Registration Section (registration@upou.edu.ph).

Step 5. The Registration Section emails the student the result; approved applications include online enrollment instructions.

Step 6. Enroll through the Online Registration System (ORS) in the Student Portal. Portal credentials are sent automatically to your registered email once enrolled.

Step 7. Log in to the Student Portal to confirm that your enrollment and courses are correct.

Step 8. UPOU TechSupport emails MyPortal (online classroom) credentials at the start of classes. For access problems, email techsupport@upou.edu.ph.

Note

- Courses offered for the term are listed on the Course Offerings page.

C. From a school outside the UP System to UPOU

Requirements

- Permit to Cross Register Form from the mother unit, approved by its Dean, Registrar, and Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs, with the student's email address indicated

Procedure

Step 1. Mail or bring the form to the Office of the University Registrar, UP Open University, National Highway, Maahas, Los Baños, Laguna 4031, or email scanned copies to the Registration Section.

Step 2. Wait for the Registration Section to email the status of the request.

Step 3. If approved, enroll in the courses following the instructions in that email.

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/cross-enrollment/

5. Application for Dropping of Courses

With the consent of the instructor and the Faculty Dean, a student may drop a course using the prescribed form before three-fourths (3/4) of the term has elapsed. Dropping without the Dean's approval may lead to curtailment or withdrawal of registration privileges.

If a course is dropped after mid-term, the faculty member indicates the student's standing at that time (Passing or Failing) for administrative guidance only.

Applications are filed through the Student Portal from the start of classes until one day after the dropping deadline (see the Academic Calendar). The fee is ₱10.00 per unit; the proof of payment is uploaded to the portal.

Procedure

Step 1. Log in to the Student Portal and apply for dropping of courses.

Step 2. Upload the proof of payment.

Step 3. Wait for email updates from the Faculty of Study (FEd, FICS, or FMDS).

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/application-for-dropping/

6. Application for Graduation

A strict “No application, no graduation” policy applies. The application is the basis for evaluating the candidate’s record. Students completing all program requirements in their last enrollment must apply on or before that term’s deadline (see the Academic Calendar).

Details on the Commencement Exercises and the graduation checklist are on the Graduation page.

Requirements

- Accomplished Application Form for Graduation (with Data Privacy Consent)

Procedure

Step 1. Submit/email the completed form to your Faculty of Study, copy furnishing the OUR Records Section: FICS – fics@upou.edu.ph; FMDS – fmds_student_support@upou.edu.ph; FEd – through its online form.

Step 2. Wait for the Faculty of Study or the OUR to email the result.

Forms / Links

- FEd online application for graduation

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/application-for-graduation/

7. Application for Honorable Dismissal

Honorable Dismissal (HD) is granted to a student who voluntarily withdraws from the University while in good standing in character and conduct. It certifies that the student has no pending accountabilities with the University.

Procedure

Step 1. Log in to the Student Portal and apply for University Clearance, selecting “Honorable Dismissal” as the reason. Attach (a) a signed letter to the University Registrar stating the reason(s) for withdrawing, and (b) a valid government-issued ID.

Step 2. Wait for the email confirming whether the clearance is approved.

Step 3. Once the University Clearance is approved, request the Honorable Dismissal and track its status in AIMS.

Reminders / Notes

- A student granted HD may no longer re-enroll in the previous program, but may apply to another UPOU program through the Online Application System (OAS).

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/application-for-honorable-dismissal/

8. Application for Leave of Absence (LOA)

A student granted an official LOA receives a final grade of DRP in currently enrolled courses, with “LOA” in the Remarks column. The LOA may not exceed one year from the effective term. Students on AWOL cannot apply for LOA and must first apply for readmission.

Applications are filed through the Student Portal, from after the deadline for withdrawal of enrollment until one day after the dropping deadline (see the Academic Calendar). The fee is ₱150.00; the proof of payment is uploaded to the portal.

Procedure

Step 1. Log in to the Student Portal and apply for leave of absence.

Step 2. Upload the proof of payment.

Step 3. Wait for email updates from the Faculty of Study (FEd, FICS, or FMDS).

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/application-for-loa/

9. Application for Make-up Examination

Only for currently enrolled students who missed an exam on its scheduled date for a valid reason (see the Academic Calendar for deadlines).

Requirements

- Accomplished Application Form for Make-Up Examination

Procedure

Step 1. Submit/email the completed form to your Faculty of Study (FEd, FICS, or FMDS), copy furnishing the OUR Records Section.

Step 2. Wait for the Faculty of Study to email further instructions.

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/application-for-make-up-exam/

10. Application for Non-Degree

A non-degree student takes certain courses without following an organized program of study and is not a candidate for any degree. Enrollment must be endorsed by the Program Chair and approved by the Faculty Dean.

Requirements

- Application Form for Non-Degree Students
- Photocopy of Transcript of Records from all schools attended
- Two identical recent 2"×2" photos and two identical 1"×1" photos, with name and program applied for written on the back

Procedure

Step 1. Check the list of course offerings on the UPOU website and complete the application form, making sure the courses listed are offered.

Step 2. At least one month before the registration schedule, mail or bring all requirements to the Registration Section, Office of the University Registrar, UP Open University, National Highway, Maahas, Los Baños, Laguna 4031, or email scanned copies.

Step 3. Wait for the OUR to email the result, which is released after approval by the Faculty Dean and the Registrar. Enrollment instructions are included in the email.

Reminders / Notes

- An approved non-degree application is valid for one term only; a new approval is needed for each subsequent term.

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/enrollment-procedure-for-non-degree/

11. Application for Readmission

Readmission from AWOL (Absence Without Official Leave) lets a student who went on AWOL resume studies. Approval is delegated to the University Registrar: the student applies to the Faculty, the Faculty endorses it to the OUR, and once approved the OUR updates the status to Active.

AWOL status does not apply to students in the Professional Teaching Certificate (PTC) program.

Procedure

Step 1. Log in to the Student Portal and click Application for Readmission.

Step 2. Upload the required documents and the proof of payment of ₱225.00.

Step 3. Wait for the application to be approved.

Step 4. Once approved, proceed with enrollment.

Reminders / Notes

- Applications received after the deadline are processed for the next term, except for graduating students and those scheduled to take the comprehensive exam.
- Students who have exceeded the Maximum Residency Rule (MRR) must file a separate application for extension or waiver of the MRR.
- Readmission from Dismissed Status (e.g., failure to meet retention rules) is approved by the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs (VCAA).
- Readmission/reinstatement from Permanent Disqualification (PDQ) is likewise approved by the VCAA.

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/application-for-readmission/

12. Application for Shifting of Program (Undergraduate)

For BAMS and BES students shifting to another UPOU undergraduate program. Associate in Arts (AA) students cannot shift to a bachelor's program; they must finish the AA first, then apply for admission to BAMS or BES.

Applicants must have earned at least 18 but not more than 36 academic units (depending on the program), with a GWA of 2.5 or better.

Guidelines / Policies

- Only continuing students within the program's Maximum Residency Rule (MRR) may shift.
- Students on AWOL must be readmitted to their current program before applying.
- Once the shift is granted, the student may not return to the previous program.

Requirements

- Accomplished Application for Shifting of Program form
- True Copy of Grades (TCG) — may be requested from the OUR via the Request Documents page

Procedure

Step 1. Submit/email the requirements to your current Faculty of Study (FEd, FICS, or FMDS) two (2) weeks before the deadline for application documents (see the Academic Calendar).

Step 2. Wait for OUR Admissions to email the result.

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/application-for-shifting-of-program/

13. Application for Transfer of Program (Graduate)

For current UPOU graduate students transferring to another UPOU graduate program before completing their current one. This does not cover MENRM/MAS/MDE students exiting through DENRM/GCAS/GCDE; they should consult their Program Chair or Faculty Office.

Guidelines / Policies

- Only continuing students within the program's Maximum Residency Rule (MRR) may transfer.

- Students on AWOL must be readmitted to their current program before applying.
- Once the transfer is granted, the student may not return to the previous program.

Requirements

- Accomplished Application for Transfer of Program form
- 500-word essay on the reason for transferring
- True Copy of Grades (TCG)
- Admission exam (if applicable)
- Other program-specific requirements

Procedure

Step 1. Submit/email the requirements to your current Faculty of Study (FEd, FICS, or FMDS) two (2) weeks before the deadline for application documents (see the Academic Calendar).

Step 2. Wait for OUR Admissions to email the result.

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/application-for-transfer-of-program/

14. Application for Transfer of Credits (TOC)

Students may apply for credit for courses equivalent in content to required courses in their UPOU degree program. See the Policy for Crediting of Courses/Transfer of Credits for undergraduate and graduate programs.

Requirements

- Clear PDF copy of the Transcript of Records (150–300 DPI)

Procedure

Step 1. Apply for TOC in the Student Portal, list the courses to be credited, and upload a clear copy of your TOR.

Step 2. The Faculty Office evaluates the application and, if needed, requires a validation examination.

Step 3. After evaluation and/or validation, the OUR checks the courses against the TOR and supporting documents.

Step 4. Once verified and approved, the credited courses appear in the student's academic record.

Reminders / Notes

- Questions about crediting go to your Faculty Office (FEd, FICS, or FMDS).

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/application-for-toc/

15. Application for Faculty of Study Clearance

A Faculty Clearance must be secured from the student's Faculty of Study before applying for University Clearance. Not applying for it delays the University Clearance.

Procedure

Step 1. FMDS students: download the Faculty of Study Clearance Form and email the completed form to FMDS. FICS students: accomplish the FICS Faculty Clearance Form online. FEd students: accomplish the FEd Faculty Clearance Form online.

Step 2. Once the Faculty Clearance is granted, apply for University Clearance through the AIMS Student Portal.

Forms / Links

- Faculty of Study Clearance Form (FMDS)
- FICS Faculty Clearance Form (online)
- FEd Faculty Clearance Form (online)

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/procedure-for-application-for-faculty-clearance/

16. Application for University Clearance

Who should file (per the UPOU Academic Policies and Procedures Manual, March 2021): graduating students; students withdrawing from the program; students transferring to another university; students applying for honorable dismissal; and students discontinuing their degree program.

An approved clearance is required before issuance of the Official Transcript of Records, Diploma, Honorable Dismissal, Transfer Credential, and Permit to Transfer.

Documents required by reason

Reason	Document(s) required
Graduation	Proof of payment of the ₱300 graduation fee
Transfer to another UP Constituent University	Signed letter to the University Registrar stating intent to transfer; admission notice or acceptance letter from the receiving university; government-issued ID
Withdrawal from the program / Honorable Dismissal	Signed letter to the University Registrar stating the reason(s) for withdrawing; government-issued ID

Procedure

Step 1. Apply for University Clearance through the Student Portal and submit the documents required for your reason (see table).

Step 2. The Office of Student Affairs, University Library, Faculty Office, and OUR Records Section act on the application; the OUR gives final approval once all have cleared the student.

Step 3. Receive the email notification that the clearance is approved.

Step 4. Download and print the approved clearance form and certificate from the Student Portal.

Reminders / Notes

- If the student has no valid, complete Official Transcript of Records (OTR) from the previous school on file, the clearance is put on hold until the original OTR is submitted to the OUR Records Section.
- Faculty Clearance must be secured before applying.
- A student cleared for Honorable Dismissal may not re-enroll in the previous program but may apply to another UPOU program through OAS.
- Processing takes 21 working days, longer if there are deficiencies; all deficiencies must be settled first.

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/application-for-university-clearance/

17. Application for Underloading (Undergraduate)

For undergraduate students (AA, AADDA, ASIT, ASIDT, AADE, BAMS, BES) enrolling below the regular load of 12 units per term (excluding PE and CWTS). Approval is required before enrollment can proceed.

Candidates for Latin honors must carry the prescribed load each term (UP University Code, Art. 414), unless the lighter load is due to justifiable causes such as health, unavailability of required courses, or being a working student.

Supporting documents by reason

- Health reasons: medical certificate from a government health facility (a private physician's certificate must be validated by one).
- Unavailable courses: approved plan of study plus a letter from the student, or a Program Chair certification that no course is available.
- Employment (full-time, about 40 hours/week): appointment paper showing duration and job description, and a certified true copy of the payslip.
- No remaining courses in the curriculum: approved plan of study plus a letter from the student, or a Program Chair certification.
- Other reasons (only if NOT running for Latin honors): letter to the Faculty Dean explaining the reason(s).

Procedure

Step 1. Log in to the Student Portal and open the Online Registration System (ORS). If your units are below the regular load, the ORS prompts you to apply for underload.

Step 2. In the ORS, click the application for Underload.

Step 3. Select the reason for underloading from the dropdown list.

Step 4. Upload supporting documents (use the Edit button beside Supporting Document to change files).

Step 5. Click Submit. A notification is emailed when the Faculty Office receives it; it is acted on by the Program Chair, Faculty Secretary, and Dean, in that order.

Step 6. The ORS notifies you of the result. If approved, continue enrolling in the ORS; if disapproved, follow your Program Chair's advice and email the PC for clarification.

Reminders / Notes

- The application opens in the Student Portal one (1) month before registration; apply early to avoid enrollment delays.
- Review the Course Offerings and the Academic Calendar (semestral or trimestral) for dates and deadlines.

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/undergraduate-students-application-for-underloading/

18. Application for Overloading

The regular load is 12 units for undergraduates and 6 units for graduate students (9 units in some terms for MIS and DCS). Taking more requires faculty approval for an overload.

Procedure

Step 1. Log in to the Student Portal and open the Online Registration System (ORS). If your units exceed the regular load, the ORS prompts you to apply for overload.

Step 2. In the ORS, click the application for Overload.

Step 3. State why you want additional courses and list them (use the Edit button beside Supporting Document to update the list).

Step 4. Click Submit. A notification is emailed when the Faculty Office receives it; it is acted on by the Program Chair, Faculty Secretary, and Dean, in that order.

Step 5. The ORS notifies you of the result. If approved, continue enrolling in the ORS; if disapproved, follow your Program Chair's advice and email the PC for clarification.

Source: https://registrar.upou.edu.ph/application-for-overloading/

Contact

Office of the University Registrar, UP Open University, National Highway, Maahas, Los Baños, Laguna, Philippines 4031

Telephone: (+6349) 536-6001 to 06 local 710 | Email: inquiries@upou.edu.ph | Monday–Friday, 8:00 AM–5:00 PM PHT

UPOU Help Desk Student Portal (AIMS) Academic Calendar Payment of Fees